

LIVE DATA SNAPSHOT — PULLED 27 FEBRUARY 2026 | 05:40 EST

INDICATOR	LATEST VALUE	PERIOD	CHANGE	SOURCE
Brent Crude	71.90 USD/bbl	2026-02-23	-\$0.85 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
WTI Crude	66.36 USD/bbl	2026-02-23	-\$0.33 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
Heating Oil NY	2.60 USD/gal	2026-02-23	+\$0.11 vs 2026-02-20	local-db (fred)
Henry Hub Nat Gas (Monthly)	7.72 USD/MMBtu	Jan 2026	+\$3.46 vs Dec 2025	local-db (fred)
US Regular Gasoline	2.94 USD/gal	2026-02-23	+\$0.01 vs 2026-02-16	local-db (fred)
US Diesel (Retail)	3.81 USD/gal	2026-02-23	+\$0.10 vs 2026-02-16	local-db (fred)
US Crude Imports	6,659 MBPD	2026-02-20	+135 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Exports	4,313 MBPD	2026-02-20	-277 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Stocks	435.8 MMbbl	2026-02-20	+16.0 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Crude Production	13,702 MBPD	2026-02-20	-33 MBPD vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Gasoline Stocks	254.8 MMbbl	2026-02-20	-1.0 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Distillate Stocks	120.4 MMbbl	2026-02-20	+0.3 MMbbl vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)
US Nat Gas Storage (Lower 48)	2,018 Bcf	2026-02-20	-52 Bcf vs 2026-02-13	local-db (eia)

Green = fresh local data · Amber = stale — verify before use · Purple = synthetic test data · Stale thresholds: daily FRED 7d · weekly FRED 10d · EIA weekly 14d · monthly series 35d

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Maritime flows through the Strait of Hormuz remain stable, facilitating ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, accounting for ~20% of globally traded petroleum. The most notable data move is the Henry Hub nat gas price, which has increased by \$3.46 to \$7.72/MMBtu, reflecting seasonal demand pressures. Brent is currently priced at \$71.90/bbl, with a widening Brent-WTI spread at \$5.54/bbl due to elevated geopolitical risk premiums. US nat gas storage has decreased by 52 Bcf to 2,018 Bcf, signaling potential supply tightness. Risk bias: Stable operational posture; asymmetric upside disruption risk.

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STRATEGIC OVERVIEW

The Strait of Hormuz remains a critical chokepoint, with ~20–21 MBPD crude and condensate transits, representing ~20% of globally traded petroleum. Key Gulf producers, including Saudi Arabia, Iraq, UAE, Kuwait, and Iran, rely heavily on this route for their export revenues. Current US production stands at 13,702 MBPD, with exports at 4,313

MBPD, underscoring the US's role in global supply dynamics. Regional geopolitical volatility preserves asymmetric disruption risk.

2 OPERATIONAL ENVIRONMENT

The operational environment remains stable, with no significant military escalations reported. The US 5th Fleet maintains a vigilant presence in the region, while the IRGCN presence sustains latent escalation potential. Coalition Maritime Forces continue to monitor shipping lanes, ensuring freedom of navigation amidst ongoing tensions.

3 COMMERCIAL SHIPPING & ENERGY MARKET INDICATORS

The largest absolute move is in Henry Hub nat gas, which has risen \$3.46 to \$7.72/MMBtu, driven by seasonal demand but not directly linked to Gulf maritime flows. Brent is currently at \$71.90/bbl, reflecting a slight decline of \$0.85 since February 20, while the Brent-WTI spread has widened to \$5.54/bbl, indicating a heightened geopolitical risk premium. WTI is priced at \$66.36/bbl, maintaining a stable position in the market.

4 72-HOUR WATCHPOINTS

Key watchpoints include Brent breaking above approximately +5% from the current \$71.90/bbl, which would signal increased market volatility. Additionally, Henry Hub exceeding \$8.00/MMBtu could indicate significant shifts in natural gas supply dynamics. Finally, any military engagement or provocations in the Strait of Hormuz, particularly involving Iranian naval forces, would serve as a critical geopolitical trigger.

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